

Spaghetti Carbonara (Variation 12)

Tags: *pasta, italian, quick, dinner* | Prep: 10 min | Cook: 20 min | Serves: 4

Ingredients

- 400 g spaghetti
- 200 g guanciale or pancetta, diced
- 4 large egg yolks
- 2 large whole eggs
- 100 g Pecorino Romano, finely grated, plus extra to serve
- 50 g Parmesan, finely grated
- Coarsely ground black pepper
- Fine salt for pasta water

Method

1. Bring a large pot of well-salted water to a rolling boil.
2. In a bowl, whisk egg yolks, whole eggs, and grated cheeses together. Season with a generous amount of coarsely ground black pepper.
3. Cook guanciale in a cold skillet over medium heat, rendering the fat slowly until crisp, about 8–10 minutes. Remove pan from heat; reserve the rendered fat.
4. Cook spaghetti in boiling water until 2 minutes before al dente. Reserve at least 300 ml pasta cooking water before draining.
5. Drain pasta and immediately add to the skillet with guanciale (off the heat). Toss to coat in the fat.
6. Add 80 ml pasta water to the egg-cheese mixture and whisk. This tempers the eggs.
7. Pour egg mixture over the pasta. Toss rapidly and continuously, adding more pasta water splash by splash, until a glossy, creamy sauce coats every strand.
8. The residual heat of the pasta cooks the eggs — if sauce looks too thick, add more pasta water.
9. Serve immediately with extra Pecorino and black pepper.

Chef Tips

- No cream — ever. Authentic carbonara sauce forms from emulsified eggs, cheese, and pasta water.
- Work quickly at the end; the window between silky sauce and scrambled eggs is narrow.
- Pasta water starch is the magic ingredient — it emulsifies and loosens the sauce. Reserve more than you think you need.